

The formula automatically reduces the 'fraction' to the simplest form, and it allows up to four characters on either side of the colon.

Be aware that the result of these formulas is actually a time value, not a fractional value. For example, the ratio of 1:8 is not the same as 1/8. Rather, it is represented internally as 1:08 am.

3.6.1.4 Rounding Values To The Nearest Fraction

Suppose you want to round a rupee amount to the nearest 25 paise. For example, if a number appears as Rs 1.65, you would like to convert it to Rs 1.75. Excel's ROUND() function seems to work only with whole numbers, but you can use Excel's ROUND() function to achieve the rounding you want. The following formula, which assumes that your value is in cell A1, will do the job for you.

```
=ROUND(A1/.25,0)*.25
```

The formula divides the original value by .25 and then multiplies the result by .25. You can, of course, use a similar formula to round values to other fractions. For example, to round a rupee amount to the nearest 5 paise, simply substitute .05 for each of the two occurrences of '.25' in the preceding formula.

3.6.1.5 Sum The Largest Values In A Range

Say you need to calculate the sum of the three largest values in a range of 100 cells. The range isn't sorted, so you can't use a SUM function. What do you do?

Excel's LARGE function returns the nth-largest value in a range, in which n is the function's second argument. You need a formula that calls the LARGE function three times and then sums the results. The following formula, which assumes the numbers are located in the range A1:A100, will do the job:

```
=LARGE(A1:A100,1)+LARGE(A1:A100,2)+LARGE(A1:A100,3)
```

Another approach is to use an array formula like this one:

```
=SUM(LARGE(A1:A100,{1,2,3}))
```